

quotiv — invoicing that never leaves your phone

****Product design · Design system · React Native****

Solo project — research, product decisions, design system, and build spec.

Short version (for a portfolio card)

> quotiv is a mobile invoicing app for freelancers and small traders. It sends quotes and invoices as PDFs, chases payment for you, and keeps every record encrypted on your own Google Drive — never on a server. I designed the product end to end: 98 screens, 16 print templates, and a 28-component design system built without a UI kit.

****One-liner:**** An invoicing app whose main feature is that it doesn't store your invoices.

The problem

Invoicing apps for sole traders split into two disappointing groups.

The free ones — Wave, Square, Zoho — give unlimited invoicing but keep your financial records on their servers, and monetise by upselling accounting suites you don't need. The paid mobile ones charge \$5–20/month and still cap you at ****3 invoices a month**** on the entry tier.

Both assume the same user: someone at a desk, running a business with a bookkeeper. The actual user I designed for is a designer, contractor, or trader billing 5–20 clients a month from a phone, often while standing on a site.

Three things follow from that, and they shaped everything:

1. ****The phone is the whole computer.**** Not a companion to a web app.
2. ****The document is the product.**** What matters isn't the app's UI — it's the PDF that lands in the client's WhatsApp.
3. ****The data is sensitive and personal.**** Invoices are financial records. Most competitors treat them as a hosting problem.

The core idea: no server

quotiv has no application backend. Records live on the device. Backups are ****encrypted on the phone and written to the user's own Google Drive**** — only the app holds the key.

This started as a privacy position and turned out to shape the business:

- ****Marginal cost per user is near zero.**** No storage, no egress, no scaling. That's what makes \$6.99/month sustainable where a cloud competitor needs more.
- ****The privacy claim is concrete, not marketing.**** "We never store your invoices" is verifiable, because there's nowhere to store them.
- ****It constrains the roadmap honestly.**** Automatic reminders that reach the client without you would need a server holding invoice data. That contradicts the promise, so quotiv doesn't do it — it reminds **you**, with a one-tap follow-up ready to send.

That last trade-off was the hardest call in the project, and I'd make it again. The privacy claim is the only genuine differentiator against free competitors; spending it on a convenience feature would have been a bad trade.

How it works

Creating a document

A full screen, not a bottom sheet — a quote with line items, dates, tax and notes is too much for a sheet once the keyboard appears.

- ****Quote / Invoice is a switch inside the screen****, so the document type is a property you can change while drafting, not a decision locked in before you start typing.
- ****The document number is assigned automatically**** and shown read-only. Users never type one, so duplicates can't happen.
- ****Line items use a combobox, not a picker.**** Start typing: if the service exists it autofills with its price and unit; if it doesn't, it becomes a one-off item with its own price — and a checkbox saves it as a service for next time. The same gesture works either way, so the one-off path quietly builds the service list.
- ****Tax is per line, not per document.**** Each item carries its own rate, so a document can mix standard-rated and exempt work — the case a single document-level rate can't express. Discount applies before tax, and the summary breaks tax out by rate.

Sending it

Tapping Save opens a ****standard Android/iOS action sheet**** — deliberately unbranded, because the user is deciding **where the document goes**, which is a system-level decision. Two actions: keep it, or send it. Sharing saves automatically, and the sheet says so.

The third option hands over entirely to the OS share sheet. I designed that surface too — not to build it, but to mark exactly where quotiv's styling stops.

Getting paid

Once a document is out, the app can't see it. So reminders are **local notifications to the seller**, not messages to the buyer:

1. A due date schedules local notifications
2. The date passes, status still unpaid → **"INV-001 · Acme Corp is 3 days overdue"**
3. Tapping it opens the invoice with a **WhatsApp deep link, message pre-written**

The user still presses send. But the app did the remembering, the deciding, and the typing.

The copy never says "reminder sent." The app didn't send anything. If someone believes it's chasing clients automatically and later finds out it isn't, that's a one-star review with a specific, quotable complaint.

Payment isn't binary either — recording a partial amount sets a **Partly paid** state with a balance, and reminders then quote the balance rather than the total.

The documents themselves

16 print templates — four designs (Classic, Modern, Minimal, Compact) × two document types × two formats (A4 and a mobile-native layout).

The mobile templates aren't scaled-down A4. They're card-based, with a "Pay Now" CTA, because a document read on a phone is a different artefact from one that gets printed.

Templates are rendered as **HTML through expo-print**, not React Native views — there's no print layout engine in RN. They're pinned to Light mode permanently: paper doesn't have a dark mode.

Free-tier documents carry a diagonal `quotiv` watermark. It's the only Pro gate the **paying** customer never sees a crown for, because it lives on the artefact rather than in the app — and the person who notices it first is usually the recipient.

Pricing

Three tiers, monthly or yearly, decided after researching what the market actually charges.

	Free	****Pro — \$6.99/mo****	****Pro+ — \$12.99/mo****
Documents	6 / month	Unlimited	Unlimited
Watermark & ads	Yes	None	None
Companies	1	1	Unlimited
Multi-currency	—	Yes	Yes
Custom branding	—	Yes	Yes
Encrypted backup	Local only	Drive	Drive
Reminders	****Yes****	Yes	Yes

Two decisions worth explaining:

****Each tier answers "which one am I?", not "how much volume do I do?"**** An earlier draft split Pro and Pro+ on document count alone, which meant nobody would ever pay the higher price — the only person who sends 180 invoices a month is running accounting software, not a phone app. Splitting on **number of companies** makes the tier about identity.

****Reminders are free.**** They're the feature most likely to bring someone back weekly, and a free tier with no reason to return gets uninstalled. Pro is sold on removals and conveniences instead.

****Ads are one full-page interstitial on the first save or share of a document**** — never on re-share, never during a reminder. Those are the moments a user is chasing money they're owed, and an ad there reads as punishing them for not being paid.

The design system

Built with ****no UI kit**** — no React Native Paper, no NativeWind. Every primitive is hand-made, which means the Figma file **is** the vocabulary rather than a mapping onto someone else's.

Colour tokens	40, Light + Dark
Type styles	13 (Rubik)
Scale tokens	35 — radii, spacing, elevation
Components	28, plus a 42-icon set
Screens	98 (phone + tablet)
Print templates	16
Prototype links	380

Every component exposes real properties — editable text, boolean toggles, instance-swap icons — so it's configured from the panel, not by digging into layers.

Contrast is measured, not eyeballed. All 27 text-on-surface pairings were computed against WCAG AA in both modes. The M3 default `outline` token failed at 4.33:1, so it was darkened until it cleared.

Three problems worth showing

Dark mode was too dark — and the cause wasn't brightness. `surfaceContainerLowest` is bound to every card in the app (371 nodes), and in Material 3's dark palette it's the *darkest* value — darker than the page behind it. Every card was sinking into the background instead of lifting off it. Brightening the page alone would have made cards look like holes. I rebuilt the ladder in greys **and inverted that token's relationship in dark mode**, then re-measured all 27 pairs.

Repetition isn't sameness. `ScreenHeader` appeared 73 times — the biggest apparent win in the file. Counting *shapes* rather than instances showed four genuinely different structures. Forcing one component over them would have meant a bloated variant set or screens quietly losing their headers. I left it alone. The raw count would have led to the wrong call.

Tablet isn't the phone stretched. Above 1024pt the bottom tabs become a navigation rail and the list stays permanently visible — so **selection replaces navigation**, which makes `selected` a real state that the phone never needed. And the create screen genuinely changes rather than rearranges: at tablet width the form and the finished document sit side by side, so preview becomes continuous feedback instead of a separate step.

What I'd do next

- **Payment collection.** No tier helps you actually get paid — no payment links, no card capture. Free competitors do this. It's the real roadmap gap, and pricing can't cover it.
- **Multi-rate tax by jurisdiction.** One flat rate per line works for GST; EU VAT with mixed rates and Indian CGST/SGST splits need more.
- **Test the free-tier cap.** Six documents a month is a guess. It should be a measurement.

Screens to show

Suggested order for a portfolio page — export at 2× from Figma:

| # | Frame | Why it earns a slot |

|---|---|---|

- | 1 | `HomeScreen` | The hook — stats, recent invoices, dark UI |
- | 2 | `NewDocumentScreen` | The core interaction: line items, per-line tax, live totals |
- | 3 | `InvoiceA4Classic` | The actual product — the document the client receives |
- | 4 | `InvoiceDetailScreen` | Partial payment state and the reminder card |
- | 5 | `ProScreen` | Pricing design and the privacy claim |
- | 6 | `TabletScreenNewDocument` | Form + live preview, the strongest single image |
- | 7 | Foundations page | Tokens, type ramp, elevation — proof of system thinking |
- | 8 | Components section | 28 components with properties |
- | 9 | `SendReminderSheet` | The honesty detail — "quotiv cannot send on your behalf" |

****A pair shot worth making:**** `InvoiceMobileClassic` beside `InvoiceA4Classic` — same document, two formats, showing the mobile version isn't a shrunken A4.